

Choices Weekend Follow-up

Graduate Training

A QED Publication

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GRADUATE TRAINING

Purpose: To provide follow up support for graduates of the Choices Weekend. Specifically, it is to provide a place where participants can continue the growth initiated in the workshops, get answers to any questions they have, and have a consistent place to get support on issues they are working on in their daily lives. Participants set specific goals they want to achieve by using the Choices concepts.

Format:

The Graduate Training is a 6-week program for graduates of the Choices Weekend. The participants meet for three hours once a week in a residential setting. The cost is \$375 per person. There is a 12-person maximum and 8 person minimum for each group.

A graduate training group should be scheduled after every Weekend.

ENROLLMENT GUIDELINES

Announce the date of the next Graduate Training at the end of a Choices Weekend with maps, times, and instructor.

Send out information and begin calling potential participants at least one month in advance.

Recruit someone to barter to hold the sessions at their house and to provide all beverages for half the cost of the Graduate Training. This person should keep an accurate record of expenses of the workshop.

Gold Cards - a maximum of two Gold Cards may be used per Graduate Training.

- *if a person uses the card as a gift they pay 1/2 the Graduate Training cost

- *if the person uses the card for themselves, they pay 1/4 the Graduate Training cost

LOGISTICS GUIDELINES

Purchase coffee (regular and decaffeinated), herbal tea, and lemons for the water.

Provide a large coffee pot and a pot of tea.

Arrange room in a circle with comfortable chairs, couches or a combination of these.

Have room and beverages ready 15 minutes prior to the meeting each week.

Pass around a sign up sheet for everyone's address and phone number.
Make a roster before the next meeting.

Prepare fresh coffee and water for the break.

Clean up the space.

GENERAL OUTLINE FOR INSTRUCTORS

Begin meetings promptly at 7:00 p.m.

First night begin with a welcome and have everyone introduce themselves and say what they want out of this six weeks. Set the **context** by sharing about yourself.

Begin each session with general sharing and teaching about that session's subject :

Session 1 - Connection

Exercise : Have people share 1) How they create connection, 2) How they connect when they are stressed or in reaction, 3) How they truly want to be in relationship. Have them share what's in their way and the difference between the way they want to do it and the way they actually do it to feel comfortable.

Session 2 - Model for Change & Reaction

Review the model. Have them each locate themselves in the model.

Exercise : Have everyone review the last 5 years of their lives: all the things they desired to do but didn't. Have them pick those that they still want to do now. Go over why they haven't done what they said or started and quit. Locate where each person stopped on the model and how to get through that point to have the result they desired.

Have everyone pick a project for the grad group.

Have everyone visualise that goal actualised, then take that feeling and create a poem about it on the break. Have them share the poems after the break.

Session 3 - Projection

Projection is the result of not feeling or being in the moment, and assuming many different things are true about others.

Exercise : Have people choose partners and pick an "A" and a "B".

- 1) "A" picks a problem they are having in a relationship and says what it is.
- 2) "A" then acts out the issue with "B" ("B" responds as if they are the person that "A" is in relationship with).
- 3) "A" names the projection and why they do it.
- 4) Then "A" says what would be there if there was no projection.

Get a project update

Session 4 - Responsibility and Intergrity Part I

Use peoples projects as the exercise for responsibility. Have everyone share how what they want to change (their project) happened in the first place. For example,

if a person wants to lose 10 lbs. as their project - being overweight is the result of more than just overeating. Overeating was the action but what was the motivation for doing that? To change something to a true place of responsibility you deal with the unconscious motivation as well as the action that created it.

- Exercise:
- 1) Have them look in their heads to see what genrally motivates them.
 - 2) Have them look in their hearts to find what values are most important to them.

(Have them write their values on the flip chart with their names and hang up the lists - save for next session.)

Session 5 - Responsibility and Integrity Part II

(put up core value charts from previous week)

Integrity is congruent with self-respect. Self respect comes from operating out of your core values.

Exercise:

- 1) Have them share where in their lives they are not in integrity with their core values
- 2) Have them talk about the results of being out of integrity.
- 3) Have them discuss what they need to handle to experience self-respect.
- 4) Ask what they commit to handle about their integrity by the last session.

Get a project update.

Session 6 - Demonstration

Review the material.

Have each participant present the results of the work they did during the program and how they plan to use the information in their lives. Have the participants support each other during their presentations.

12/11/90